Determination of the Height and Width of NeckLine

The height and the width of the neckline vary from person to person. It should be fixed before drafting the diagram. For a neckline, width and depth are required as explained below (Figure 12.16).

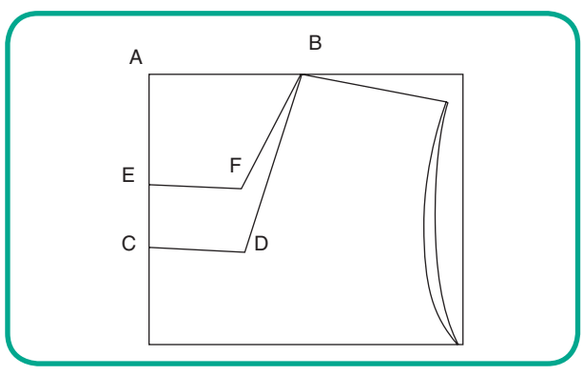


Figure 12.16 Size of Neckline

A – B = Front and back neck width

A – C = Front neck depth

B – D – C = Front neckline

A – E = Back neck depth

B – F – E = Back neckline

12.3.3 Neckline Finishing

Finishing of the neckline is of great importance. It affects the final appearance of the garment and also undergoes much strain while wearing the dress especially dresses without fasteners. Hence the neckline finish must be stronger. Neckline finish increases the durability of the garment. It should retain the shape and size. Mostly bias strips are used to finish the necklines, because of its stretchability. Most necklines are finished in one of the following three ways :

- With facings.
- With bindings.
- With a collar.

The major points to be considered while finishing the neckline are :

- Neckline edges must retain shape and must not stretch (curves & corners).
- Seam must be thin and smooth.
- Facing edges must be beneath the collar/neckline .

12.3.3.1 Bias Piece

A true bias is a diagonal line at 45° to the lengthwise or crosswise grain. It has the maximum elasticity more than any other direction in the cloth. Bias stripes can be applied as facings and bindings and especially used for finishing curved edges such as neckline, sleeveless, armholes and scallops.

Cutting Bias Strips

Fold the fabric diagonally so that the lengthwise threads of the folded part fall parallel to the crosswise threads on the rest of the material. Using a ruler, measure from the fold to desired width of bias strip (usually 2- 2.5 cm) and draw parallel lines. Cut along the marked lines and trim off ends along the warp threads.

Joining of Bias Strips

Place the bias stripes with their right sides facing each other. The edges of the cut ends should coincide. Shift the top strip 0.5 cm beyond the other so that the sharp points at the ends of the strips project on either side. Stitch a 0.5 cm seam joining the points where the sides of the two stripes intersect. Press the seam open and trim the seam projection (Figure 12.17).

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